

ABDI IFA WOMEN AND CHILDREN DEVELOPMENT ORGANIZATION PROPOSAL



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ABDI IFA WOMEN AND CHILDREN DEVELOPMENT ORGANIZATION
Dhaabbata Misooma Dubartootaa fi Daa'immanii Abdii Ifaa

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1. Background

Abdi Ifa Women and Children Development Organization (AIWCDO) was founded on the collaborative efforts of individuals and a church group to support vulnerable people. The organization's roots trace back to **2010**, when Semiret Geletu and Kasayenesh Siyoum began helping HIV-positive women and female prisoners in Ejere, Ethiopia. Initially, they used their own resources, supplemented by donations of money, clothing, and other items from a few volunteers.

In **2012**, their work expanded through a partnership with the Diakonia group, a humanitarian ministry within the Ejere Rehobot Mekane Yesus Congregation. Diakonia provided charity support to the poor through monthly contributions from congregation members and income-generating projects like preparing snacks, running a small shop, and growing vegetables.

This collaboration allowed them to provide holistic support to both HIV-positive women and female prisoners in the town. They distributed essential supplies, including food, hygiene products, and pocket money. Their approach also included spiritual programs and counseling to help participants transform their lives. The group worked with local government offices, such as the woreda health and women and children's offices, to identify and screen women in need.

By September 2022, the ministry's scope grew to include outreach to commercial sex workers. The goal of this initiative was to help these women become productive, self-sufficient members of society through spiritual guidance and counseling.

The desire to address these problems on a larger scale and formalize their efforts led to the establishment of the Abdi Ifa Women and Children Development Organization in 2024. This formal registration allows them to expand their reach and connect with a wider network of people and institutions globally to better serve women and children in need.

Initiative to reach out Commercial Sex Workers

A compassionate response from Gelila Hotel owner Wodinesh Minaleshoa to the struggles of commercial sex workers within her establishment became the genesis of a humanitarian initiative. Moved by their personal stories, she initially offered direct assistance to a small number of women, providing them with a safe haven in her own home. However, she quickly realized the limitations of her personal resources in addressing the scale of the problem.

Her daughter, Kasayenesh Siyum, inherited this vision and expanded the effort by gathering support from like-minded friends who were already engaged in humanitarian work. Despite their collective efforts, the project faced a significant challenge: a growing number of women seeking to leave their dangerous lives far exceeded the limited resources the group could gather from individuals. This resource scarcity constrained their ability to provide comprehensive training and support, limiting the number of participants they could help.

After two years of this journey, the group recognized the need for a more sustainable and structured approach. To secure the funding necessary to expand their impact and reach more women, they decided to establish a formal, legally registered organization. This led to the creation of the Abdi Ifa Women and Children Development Organization, a non-governmental organization dedicated to formally addressing the challenges faced by these vulnerable women.

2. Statement of the Problem

Commercial sex workers in Ejere Town face a cycle of severe exploitation, trauma, and economic desperation. Many enter the trade due to extreme poverty, lack of education, and primary care giving responsibilities. Despite a high desire to leave this dangerous life, these women lack:

- ❖ **Safe Alternatives:** Without temporary housing and food security, they are forced to remain in high-risk hotel environments.

- ❖ **Marketable Skills:** Lack of vocational training prevents entry into the formal economy.
- ❖ **Psychological Support:** Untreated trauma and social stigma hinder their ability to reintegrate into society. Previous local efforts have been overwhelmed by the scale of the crisis, leading to a critical need for structured, well-resourced intervention.

3. Project Objectives:

3.1.General Objective:

To empower commercial sex workers in low-income communities with practical life skills and economic tools for improved livelihoods and self-sufficiency.

3.2. Specific Objectives:

- To train 100 commercial sex workers in life skills such as communication, parenting, budgeting, and emotional well-being.
- To provide basic vocational or income-generating skills (e.g., HCB production and small-scale business).
- To link participants with local support services, microfinance institutions, and business mentorship.
- To foster peer support networks among single mothers for ongoing emotional and social support.

4. Project Scope

4.1. Project Location

The project is situated in Ejere Town, the administrative center of Ejere Woreda within the West Shoa Zone of the Oromia Region, Ethiopia. Located approximately 50 kilometers west of Addis Ababa along the strategic highway to Ambo

4.2. Target Group:

- **Beneficiaries:** 100 commercial sex workers aged 18–45, living in low-income areas of Ejere town
- **Selection Criteria:** Priority will be given to women who are working as commercial sex workers, with limited or no income, little formal education, and primary care giving responsibilities.

4.3. Project Duration:

Four months, including mobilization, training, follow-up, and evaluation.

- One month to mobilize
- Three months for train, job opportunity creation, running an income generation start-up for self-reliance, and evaluation.

5. KEY ACTIVITIES & IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

5.1. Key Activities:

Activity	Description
Community mobilization	Awareness campaign and beneficiary identification in collaboration with local leaders. Bureau of women affair,
Life skills training	Workshops on self-esteem, parenting, communication, time, and stress management.
Financial literacy & budgeting sessions	Teaching how to save, plan, and manage household income.
Vocational skills training	Provide comprehensive vocational training in practical trades aligned with local market demands, like Hollow Concrete Block (HCB) production, Poultry farming, bakery, garment production...Based on their skill and interest.
Mentorship and business coaching	Link women with mentors or local entrepreneurs for guidance and support.
Group formation and support networks	Form peer support groups for encouragement, shared childcare, and advice.
Monitoring & evaluation	Collect feedback, success stories, and assess program impact.
Loaning	Arranging seed loan for business start up

Activity	Description
Block production	Produce building block for income-generation, some of the women will be hired in the business.
Poultry farm	Poultry farm starting by 3,000 chickens for income generation & creating job opportunity for some of the participant in the project.

5.2 Implementation Plan

Month 1: Mobilization Phase

Goal: Prepare the **ground** for the project by engaging stakeholders, building trust, and organizing resources.

Key Activities:

- **Community Entry & Sensitization**
 - Meet with local leaders, elders, and gatekeepers.
 - Conduct community sensitization meetings to explain project goals and gain buy-in.
- **Stakeholder Mapping & Engagement**
 - Identify and map local stakeholders (government bodies; worad women's office, social affairs and local NGOs).
 - Form a community development committee (CDC) or strengthen existing structures.
- **Needs Assessment**
 - Conduct participatory rural appraisal (PRA) or baseline surveys to assess community priorities and resources.
- **Resource Planning**
 - Finalize budget, logistics, and human resource allocations.
 - Hire field officers or mobilize from the community if possible.

Month 2-4: Training Phase, Follow-Up & Implementation Phase

Goal:

- Support the community in applying what they've learned and implementing small-scale development actions.
- Build the capacity of community members and leaders to implement sustainable development actions.

- Measure impact, document outcomes, and plan for sustainability or project handover.

Key Activities:

- **Capacity Building Workshops**
 - Topics may include leadership, project management, financial literacy, entrepreneurship, poultry farming, WASH (Water, Sanitation & Hygiene), or any area relevant to the development goal.
- **Train-the-Trainer Programs**
 - Select key community members and equip them to cascade knowledge to others.
- **Life Skills & Soft Skills Training**
 - Focus on communication, conflict resolution, teamwork, and problem-solving.
- **Hands-on Demonstrations**
 - E.g., improved hand craft techniques, water purification, or small business development.
- **Field Support & Coaching**
 - Regular field visits to mentor trainees and support ongoing community-led initiatives.
- **Small Grant Distribution (if applicable)**
 - Disburse small community project funds for implementation (with proper monitoring).
 - This is an endowment fund that recycles over the period.
- **Progress Monitoring**
 - Midline assessments using surveys, checklists, and feedback sessions.
- **Problem-Solving Forums**

- Create safe spaces to share challenges, brainstorm solutions, and encourage collaboration.
- **Final Evaluation**
 - Use qualitative and quantitative tools to assess impact (e.g., focus groups, outcome indicators).
- **Impact Stories**
 - Document testimonials, case studies, and success stories for visibility and learning.
- **Lessons Learned Workshop**
 - Engage community members to reflect on what worked, what didn't, and what's next.
- **Sustainability Planning**
 - Strengthen income-generating activity. The trainers will be encouraged to create their small businesses, and this organization (Abdi Ifa) also runs a small business to support the running cost as well as to cover part of the expense of the projects with its own resources.
 - Build up community governance structures (e.g., CDC), link to local government or NGOs.
 - Identify champions to lead future efforts.
- **Handover & Celebration**
 - Formal event to recognize efforts, share results, and transition responsibilities to the community.

6. Market Saturation Risk

The selection of Hollow Concrete Block (HCB) production is strategically insulated from market saturation risks due to the project's unique geographic and institutional advantages. Located in Ejere Town along the strategic highway to Ambo and only 50 kilometers from the expanding capital, Addis Ababa, the site sits within a high-growth construction corridor where demand for building materials is consistently

high. Furthermore, the project avoids over-reliance on a single output by offering a diverse vocational mix including poultry farming, bakeries, and garment production based on real-time "local market demands". By establishing its own production site and hiring participants directly, the organization secures an immediate internal market and job opportunities for the women, while the sustainability plan further buffers against risk by linking participants with local government affirmative action plans and established women's cooperatives.

7. Expected Outcomes:

Expected Outputs by the end of 4 Months:

- The project will yield 100 participants successfully completing a four-month intensive program of safe housing, professional counseling, and spiritual restoration.
- Some marriages will be saved because the impact of negative outside influences is eliminated as these women transition away from commercial sex work result marital stability and social impact.
- The trainers will be empowered as productive, self-sufficient members of society, breaking the cycle of poverty and exploitation.
- Stronger community leadership and structures
- At least 1–3 community-led projects implemented
- Increased skills in targeted areas (in running small-scale business, health, education, etc.)
- Clear plan for sustainability or next phase
- One building HCB production site, 60 women running their small business, and involved in a saving scheme.
- 100 commercial sex worker women trained in life and vocational skills
- 80% of participants demonstrate improved confidence and life management
- 60% start a small business or income-generating activity
- Strengthened local partnerships with community-based organizations and local businesses

8. Budget Estimate:

A. Plan for Hollow Concrete Block (HCB) production

No	Description	Estimated Budget (USD)
1	HCB production machine	\$7,900
2	Machine planting	\$132
3	Raw material/In put	\$1,520
4	Supplementary equipment	\$516
5	Water & electricity (installation & utility cost)	\$920
6	Contingency cost 10%	\$ 1,098.8
	Total	\$12,086.8

Local contribution for HCB production

No	Item	Estimated cost
1	Shade for production	\$1,387
2	Safety wearing	\$130
3	Machine operator labor cost	\$130
4	Daily laborers cost	\$120
5	Guard	\$40
6	Land renting cost	\$66
7	Land leveling & site clearing	\$132
8	Office Equipment	\$130
9	Seed money (loaning and grants from local partner)	\$400
10	Contingency cost 10%	\$ 253.50

	Total	\$2,788.5
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B. An Alternative Plan to Poultry Farming

No	Description	Estimated Cost (USD)
1	Purchase 3,000 chicken	\$2,665
2	Food 18quintal per 10,500 birr	\$1,422
3	Feeding instrument	\$208
4	Medication & sanitization	\$198
5	Safety	\$130
7	Renting hall for growing chicken	\$27
9	Electricity installation	\$329
10	Electricity & water utility	\$119
12	Contingency cost 10%	\$510
	Total	\$5,608.0

Local contribution for Poultry Farming

No	Description	Estimated Cost (USD)
1	Charcoal	\$30
2	Labor cost	\$231
3	To train 20 participant in poultry farming one week	\$237
5	Seed Money for business startup (grants by local or earlier supporter)	\$500
6	Contingency cost 10%	\$99.8

	Total Estimated Budget	\$1,097.8
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Living Cost for 100 Ladies Leaving from Hotel

No	Description	Unit	Unit price	Quantity (4 month)	No of ladies	Estimated amount for 4 month (USD)
1	Restoration House rent	Month	\$6.58	4	100	\$2,632
2	Mattress bed	No	\$23.7	1	100	\$23.7
3	Blanket & sheet	No	\$13.2	1	100	\$13.2
4	Food expense	Month	\$17	4	100	\$6,800
5	Sanitation	Month	\$4	4	100	\$1,600
6	Contingency cost 10%					\$1,106.9
	Total					\$12,175.8

Local contribution for Living Cost for 100 Ladies Leaving from Hotel

No	Description	Unit	Unit price	Duration (4 month)	Quantities	Estimated Cost for 4 month (USD)
1	Psychotherapist	Month	\$100	4	3	\$300
2	Training room	Month	\$75	4	1	\$75
3	Mentor	Month	\$75	4	2	\$75
4	Clinical protocol for trauma recovery	Lump sum				\$1,000

5	Clinic	Month				\$150
6	Contingency cost 10%					\$160
	Total					\$1,760

BUDGET SUMMARY

Category	Estimated Cost	Local Contribution
HCB Production	\$12,086.8	\$2,788.5
Poultry Farming	\$5,608.0	\$1,097.8
Living & Restoration	\$12,175.8	\$1,760.0

The project requires funding for key components including HCB production, poultry farming, and participant support. The estimated budget for HCB production is approximately **USD 12,086.8**, while local contributions amount to **USD 2,788.5**.

The poultry farming component requires approximately USD **\$5,608.0** with additional local contributions of USD **\$1,097.8**. Living and restoration costs for 100 participants over four months are estimated at **\$12,175.8** with local contribution of **\$1,760.0**.

9. Sustainability Plan:

- AIWCDO will operate its own income-generating HCB site and poultry farm to cover ongoing organizational costs. Graduates will be enrolled in Village Savings and Loan Associations (VSLA) to ensure financial resilience.
- Participants will be linked with local women's groups and cooperatives for continued support.
- Encourage group savings schemes (e.g., Village Savings and Loan Associations - VSLA).
- Train local women leaders to continue basic mentorship after the project end.

- Opening a poultry farm as an activity of income generation for the organization, and some of the participant also hired in it to earn their living.

10. Partners and Stakeholders:

10.1. Local government (social welfare departments)

Roles and contributions of Local government (social welfare departments)

- Protect women from abuse, neglect, and exploitation.
- Provide parenting education and support programs.
- Providing essential services like health education, counseling, and support for access to reproductive health services.
- Establishing schools, learning centers, and scholarship programs to ensure girls and women can access quality education.
- Offering vocational training, financial literacy programs, and support for entrepreneurial activities to create livelihoods.

10.2. Local Health Centers working with Abdi Ifa through

- They work with NGOs to conduct health education programs, raise awareness about hygiene, nutrition, and disease prevention, and address cultural or socio-economic barriers to healthcare access.
- Provide professional psychological counseling and trauma recovery services for the 100 project participants.

11. Monitoring and Evaluation:

- Pre- and post-training surveys
- Participant success stories and case studies
- Monthly reports and a final project evaluation

12. Risk Mitigation

To counter market saturation, vocational training is diversified across multiple sectors based on real-time market demand. Resource risks are managed through strong local government backing and affirmative action policies for small-scale industries.

13. Conclusion:

Investing in this project is a critical commitment to breaking the cycle of exploitation and generational poverty for 100 women currently trapped in commercial sex work. By providing a holistic pathway that combines spiritual restoration and professional counseling with high-demand vocational skills, the initiative transforms vulnerable individuals into self-sufficient entrepreneurs and stable providers for their children. Empowering these women does more than change individual lives; it removes them from high-risk environments, restores their dignity, and creates a scalable blueprint for social stability and economic growth within the Ejere Town community and the broader West Shoa Zone.

Appendix I

Below is a success story of a girl supported by the Diakonia group in the church

MuntahaTair was a young girl who returned from one of the Arab countries because of mental illness. She is from a poor Muslim family, and they couldn't afford the treatment she needed to have. She escaped from home and went to a different town and wandered on the streets that, which exposed her to sexual harassment. Due to her severe suffering, the Diakonia group decided to take her to a rehabilitation home in the church compound. Since she got a fistula problem due to excessive harassment, the Diakonia group went through a tough time to treat her. After receiving a recommendation letter from the respected government offices, the Diakonia group brought her to the hospital. Fortunately, after two months of medication and prayer, she was healed and reunited with her family.

Gadise Sebisa was a single mother who was living in Addis Alem Town with her child and husband. Her husband abandoned her after she got pregnant with her second child as he said he wasn't ready for another baby. She has been working as a daily laborer with a small amount of payment. She was all by herself except her 3 years old child when she gave birth and no one was there to support her. She didn't have anything to eat at home; she didn't even have a mattress to sleep on. Finally, the Diaconia group heard about her and visited her and brought her food, clothes, and mattress. They helped her through her tough days. Currently, her boys (7 and 10) years old are accepted into the compassion international children development program (Et-545 project) in Ejere Rohobot Mekane Yesus Congregation. Her two boys are living with their father and she left for the Arab Country for work.

14. Legal and Institutional Framework

The proposal could benefit from a brief mention of legal registration status, governance structure, and how it aligns with national development goals or policies.

The Women's Policy first and foremost aims to institutionalize the political, economic, and social rights of women in order to create an appropriate structure in government offices and institutions that the public policies and interventions are gender-sensitive and can ensure equitable development for all Ethiopian men and women. Women are getting due attention by the current government. In the Five Year Strategic Plan there are affirmative action plans in education sectors, organizing for small scale industry, and poverty reduction programs as well as a job creation agenda. The grass root structure, the Woreda women bureau, is entitled to work with government and nongovernmental organizations over women issues. Abdi Ifa Women and Children Development is a licensed organization working in Addis Alem Town, and was given recognition by the government offices like, the Woreda Women and Children's Affair Office, and Woreda Health